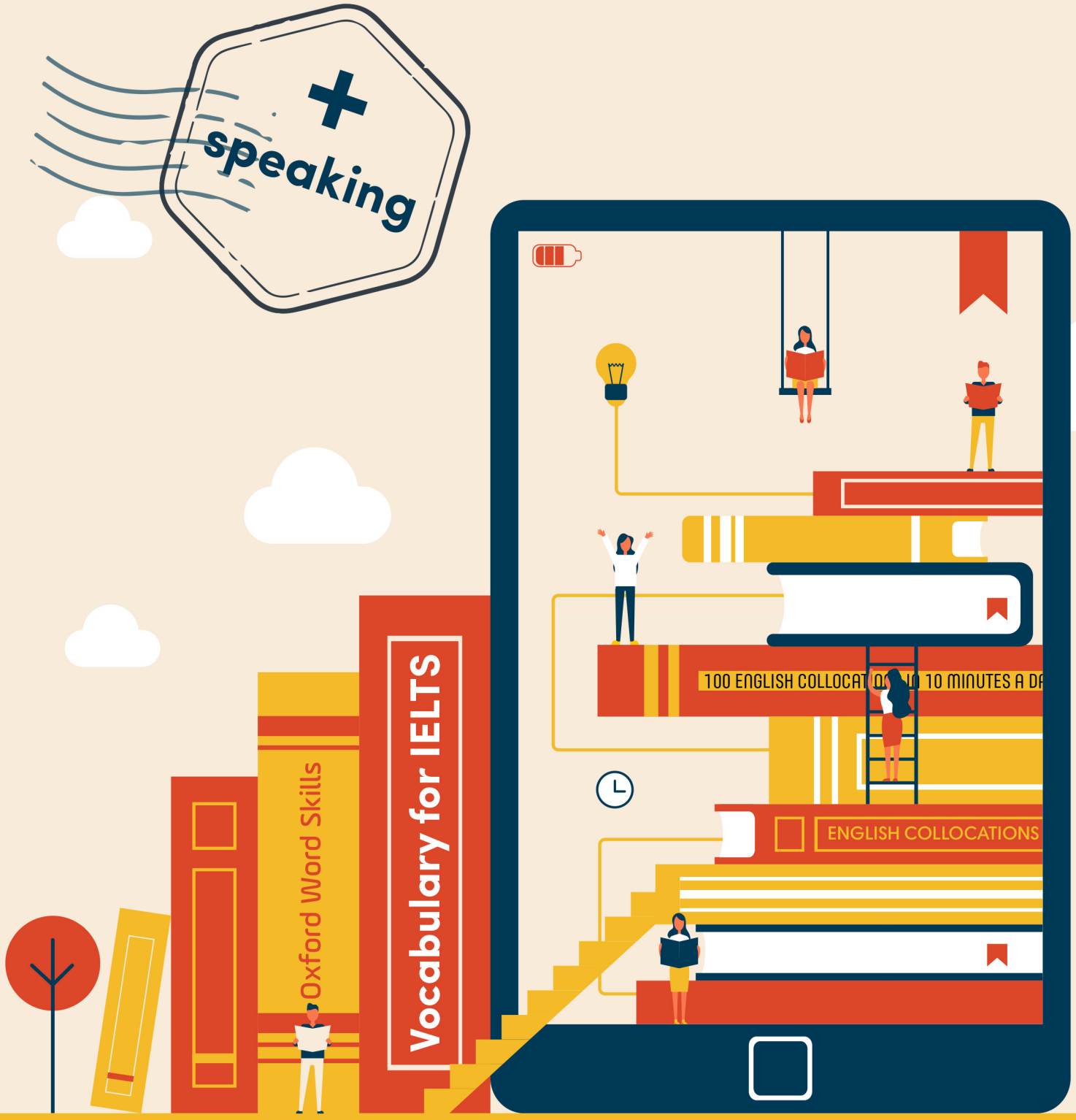
IELTS Up Words!

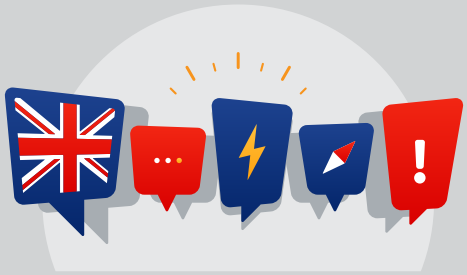
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Lesson 71: Agriculture

Hello, and welcome to lesson seventy-one of IELTS Up Words! In this lesson, we are going to look at the topic of agriculture. We have already covered the topic of farming in lesson twenty,but agriculture is a much broader term that encompasses farming as well as field cultivation. It also includes the ranching industry. Ranching is the practice of raising herds of animals on large areas of land where they can graze.

In this lesson, let's improve our listening even further by listening to someone talk about agriculture.

Ready? Make sure to take notes of important information.

Agriculture is extremely vulnerable to climate change. Changes in our climate bring about higher temperatures, which in turn inevitably result in reduced yields of desirable crops. Of course, not everything is depleted, and these harsh conditions encourage the growth of weeds and also allow pests to proliferate. This inevitably leads to a greater use of chemical pesticides by farmers. The poor quality of our soil stems from this.

Climate change also produces more extreme weather patterns. These can range from long stretches of drought and also, conversely, extremely heavy rain, which can cause floods. The destruction of food crops can result from both a lack or a surfeit of water.

Certain human activities also have a negative impact on agriculture. Firstly, farming practices themselves can be damaging. The use of heavy machinery, like tractors, can compact the soil. This means that, rather than soaking into the ground, rainwater runs off it, carrying the soil with it, and so leads to an increase in erosion. Soil erosion can be prevented if there is enough vegetation. So clearly, overgrazing by cattle, which removes the vegetation, leads to a loss of soil.

Urban development due to an increased population also takes its toll, as trees are cleared to make way for houses. Deforestation is one of the main causes of soil degradation in the world today. It seems that housing our growing population comes at the cost of providing much-needed food. So, it is not surprising that farmers are turning to genetically modified crops to try to boost productivity and grow crops in more ecologically healthy fields while allowing more efficient use of resources. This technology means that farmers can grow crops that are resistant to diseases or pests, so fewer chemicals are used.

Did you get the gist of this listening? Needless to say, you don't need to use all these words in your IELTS speaking test. You don't need to know the meaning of words like irrigation or desalination to score high in the speaking part of the test. This section was actually taken from the book "Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced," lesson fifteen, and was meant to improve your listening. So, don't get intimidated by all the big words we had in this lesson. Haha!

Speaking Tip

The Cause-and-Effect Language

Use the following words and phrases when talking about a cause and an effect:

- bring about: Changes in our climate bring about higher temperatures.
- result in: They result in reduced yields of desirable crops.
- lead to: This inevitably leads to greater use of chemical pesticides by farmers.
- to stem from something: The poor quality of our soil stems from this.
- due to: Urban development is due to an increased population.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
it encompasses farming	it includes farming	شامل کشاورزی می‌شود	incorporate
field cultivation	the act of preparing the land and growing crops on it, or the act of growing a particular crop	کشت زمین	to cultivate cultivator
ranching	the activity of keeping animals on a very large farm	دامداری؛ دامپروری	Rancher livestock (= animals and birds that are kept on a farm, such as cows, sheep, or chickens) cattle (= a group of cows or other livestock)
raising herds of animals	to look after a large group of animals so that they can be sold or used as food	نگهداری از گلهٔ حیوانات	a herd of cattle/ elephants/goats
to graze	to (or cause animals to) eat grass	چریدن؛ به چرا بردن	pasture (= land covered with grass or similar plants suitable for animals, such as cows and sheep, to eat)
reduced yields of desirable crops	decreased volume of the produced crops	بازدهی کاهش‌یافتهٔ محصولات زراعی مطلوب	high/low yield an increase/ reduction in yield
to deplete	to reduce something in size or amount, especially supplies and energy	کاهش دادن	depletion of resources
the growth of weeds	an increase in the size and amount of wild plants that grow where they are not wanted	رشد علف‌های هرز	annual/future/long-term growth
pest proliferation	a sudden increase in the amount or number of destructive insects or other animals that attack crops	تکثیر آفات	to proliferate
long stretches of drought	long periods when there is little or no rain	دوره‌های طولانی‌مدت خشکسالی	long stretches of time

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
a surfeit of water	an amount of water that is more than is needed	مقدار بیش‌ازحد آب	be surfeited with/on
heavy machinery, like tractors	large pieces of machinery or equipment, such as tractors	ماشین‌آلات سنگین، مانند تراکتور	agricultural/ industrial/factory machinery
to compact the soil	to press the soil together in a tight and solid way	فشرده‌کردن خاک	compact (adjective)
soil erosion	refers to the gradual disappearance of the top layer of soil by the natural physical forces, or through forces associated with farming activities	فرسایش خاک	to erode water/wind erosion to suffer (from) erosion
deforestation	the cutting down of trees in a large area, or the destruction of forests by people	جنگل‌زدایی؛ قطع درختان جنگل	to deforest
soil degradation	the physical, chemical and biological decline in soil quality	فروسایش خاک	soil retrogression
to boost the productivity of your crops	to increase the amount of yield produced by your crops	افزایش بهره‌وری محصولات زراعی‌تان	to enhance/uplift productivity
ecologically healthy fields	fields full of grass, clover, wild herbs, and flowers that provide the animals with a varied and healthy diet	زمین‌هایی که از نظر زیست‌محیطی سالم هستند	
irrigation	the act of watering land so that crops and plants will grow	آبیاری	an irrigation system irrigated land/ farms/crops
desalination of seawater	the process of removing minerals from seawater	شیرین‌سازی آب دریا	to desalinate/desalt

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
conversely	in a contrasting or opposite way	متقابلاً؛ برعکس	converse
rainwater runs off the ground	when rain falls onto the earth and moves along the surface	آب باران بر سطح زمین جاری می‌شود	
urban development	the development or improvement of an urban area through construction	توسعهٔ شهری	negative impacts of urban development
to make way for houses	to provide space for building houses	ایجاد فضا برای ساخت خانه	
to house our growing population	to provide our increasing population with a place to live	اسکان‌دادن جمعیت روبه‌رشد	to accommodate
do not get intimidated	do not fear; do not be scared by	نترسید؛ وحشت‌زده نشوید	intimidating



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